

2.2 Variables

A very common concept that is found in most scripting and programming languages is that of the variable. This can be considered as a container that holds data and can be used later on when necessary. In Flash ActionScript a letter or any particular word is assigned to identify such a variable. The user can also assign numeric values and characters to it. A variable is primarily used to store values, and the var statement is mainly used for declaring those variables. For example:

```
var x; // a variable x is declared
```

If the var statement is omitted while declaring a variable, a compilation error in strict mode and run-time error in standard mode will be displayed. For example consider the following statement:

```
i; // error will occur if i was not previously defined
```

On the other hand, when the user wants to declare a variable of a particular data type, say an int, the following declaration must be given:

```
var x:int;
```

Besides this, a variable can also be assigned a value by using the (=) operator. For example, the following code declares a variable k and assigns the value 20 to it:

```
var k:int;  
k = 20;
```

The user can also declare and initialize an array or instantiate an instance of a class. The following code shows an array that is declared and is also assigned relevant values.